

I told Bina about my plan, and she was delighted. But she was a bit sceptical too.

‘I can’t imagine you staying away from the market for more than a week; by the eighth day you will be suffering withdrawal symptoms and dying to get behind the trading screen,’ she said with mock annoyance.

‘Not this time, my dear. If nothing else, I will stick to my plan just to prove you wrong,’ I said.

‘But I fear the allure of your mistress will easily outweigh your desire to prove the wife wrong,’ Bina persisted.

‘The mistress will have to wait for a month,’ I said.

‘Really? I will believe it only at the end of the month,’ Bina said, still not fully convinced.

I had bought a plot of land at Murbad six months ago. I wanted to spend my weekends there and grow vegetables. The turbulence in the market had kept me busy and I never got around to doing it. I finally had time on my hands to pursue my dream.

My morning walks had stopped after trading hours were advanced by an hour to 9 a.m. I used to work out on the treadmill, but that was no match to enjoying the pleasant morning air in the company of my friends in the housing society I lived in.

I also realized I had not been in touch with many of my relatives for a while now. Thanks to Facebook, I had reconnected with some of my close school friends, but had not met up with them despite promising them I would. I wanted to learn a bit of basic cooking too. For that I could not have a better tutor than Bina. And, as she managed the house so well, I had never troubled myself with the academic and personal progress of my children. I would now get to know them better as a father. Then there were the many movies I had missed last year. And suddenly, it seemed a month would be too little for the plans I had drawn up.

But even as I was busy with morning walks, movies, cooking and social calls, I kept track of the market. I got back to work in the first week of February 2012, fully refreshed from my month-long break.

Even though the economy was showing signs of slowing and the government was unable to push through any major reforms, the market continued its climb. But not for long. The mood changed for the worse towards the end of February, but the IPO of commodity bourse Multi Commodity Exchange (MCX) got an overwhelming response. MCX was